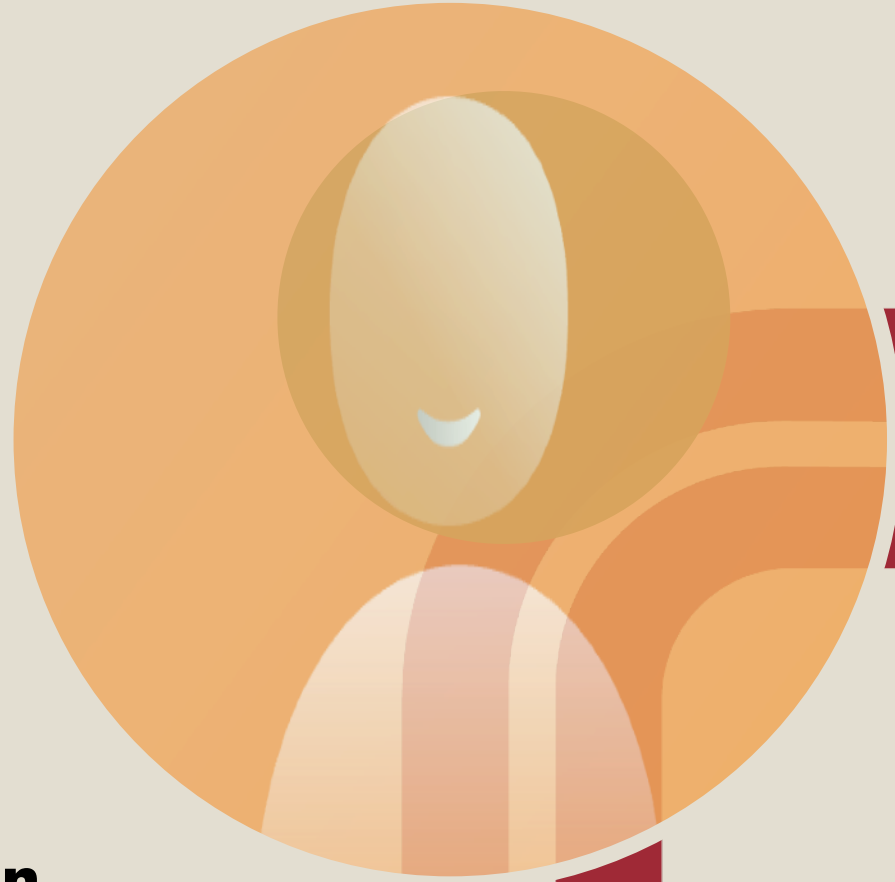
Widening the Table:

An Ethics of Accessible Exegesis and Interpretation

Stephen Stringer, Phd



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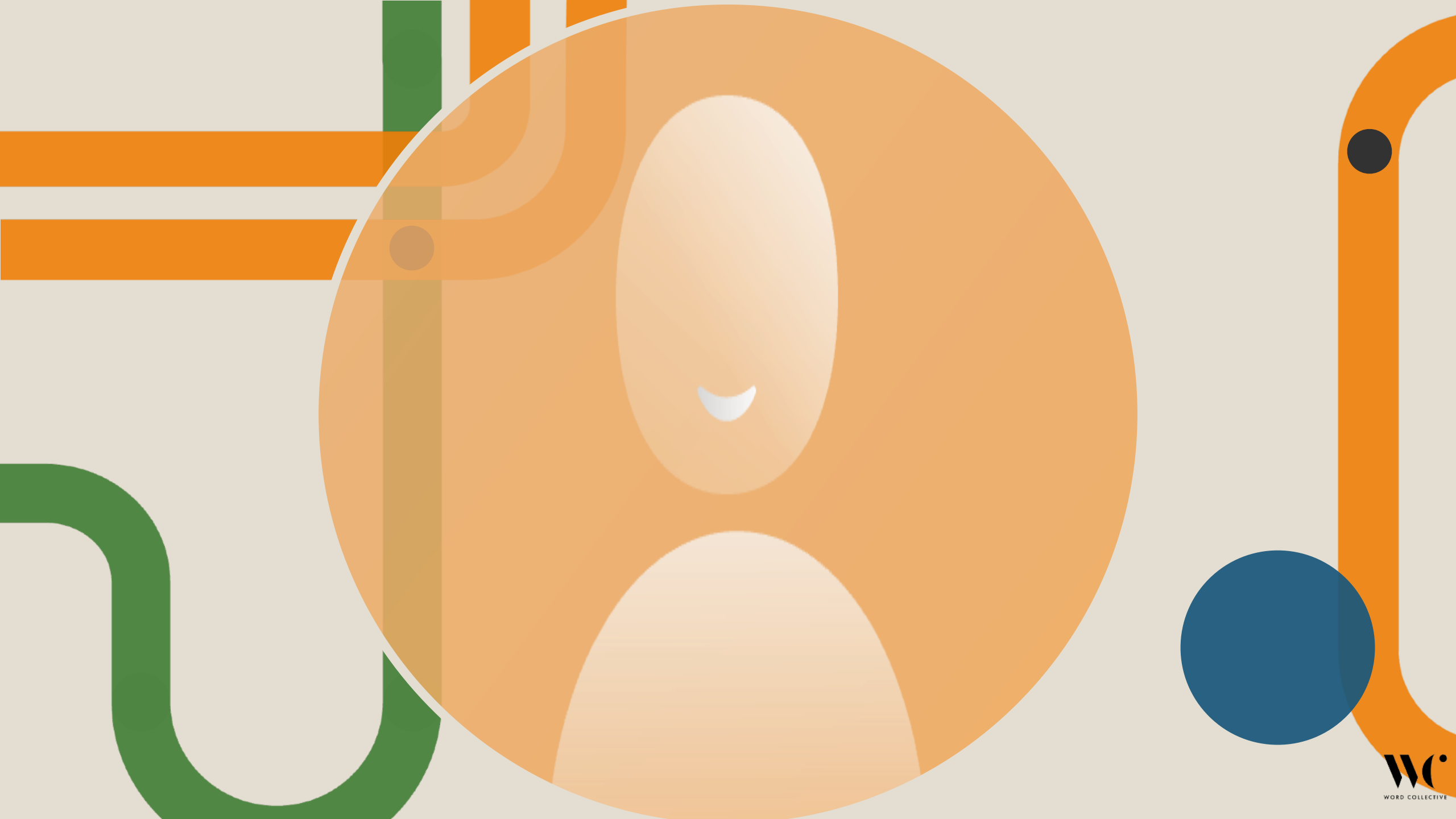

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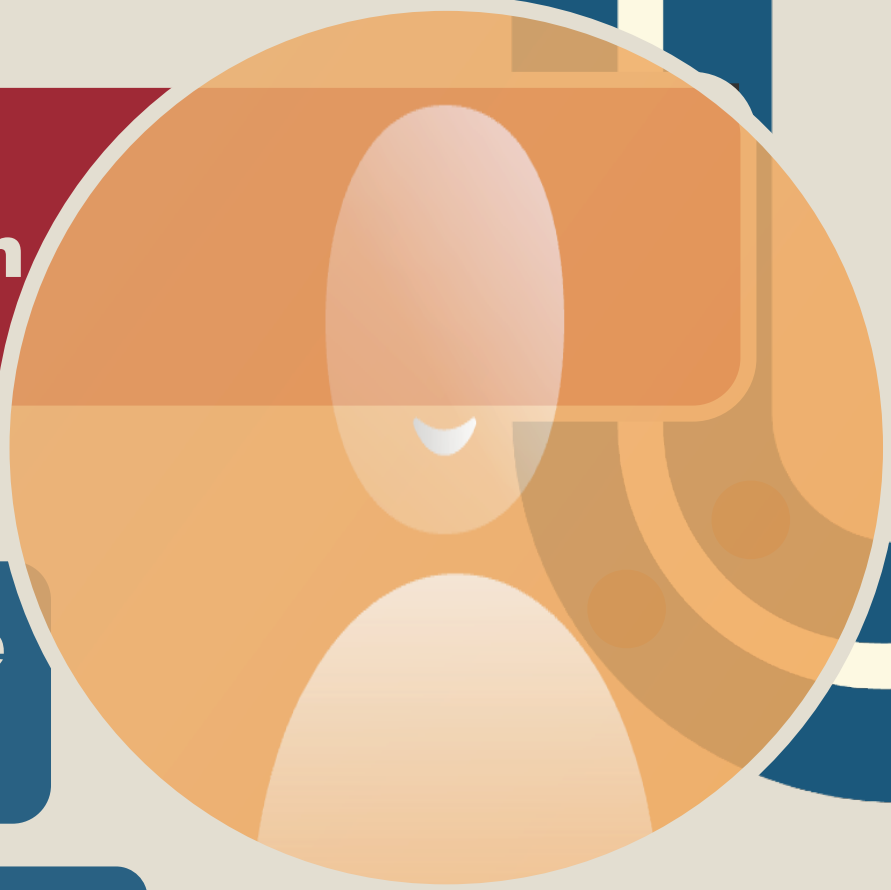
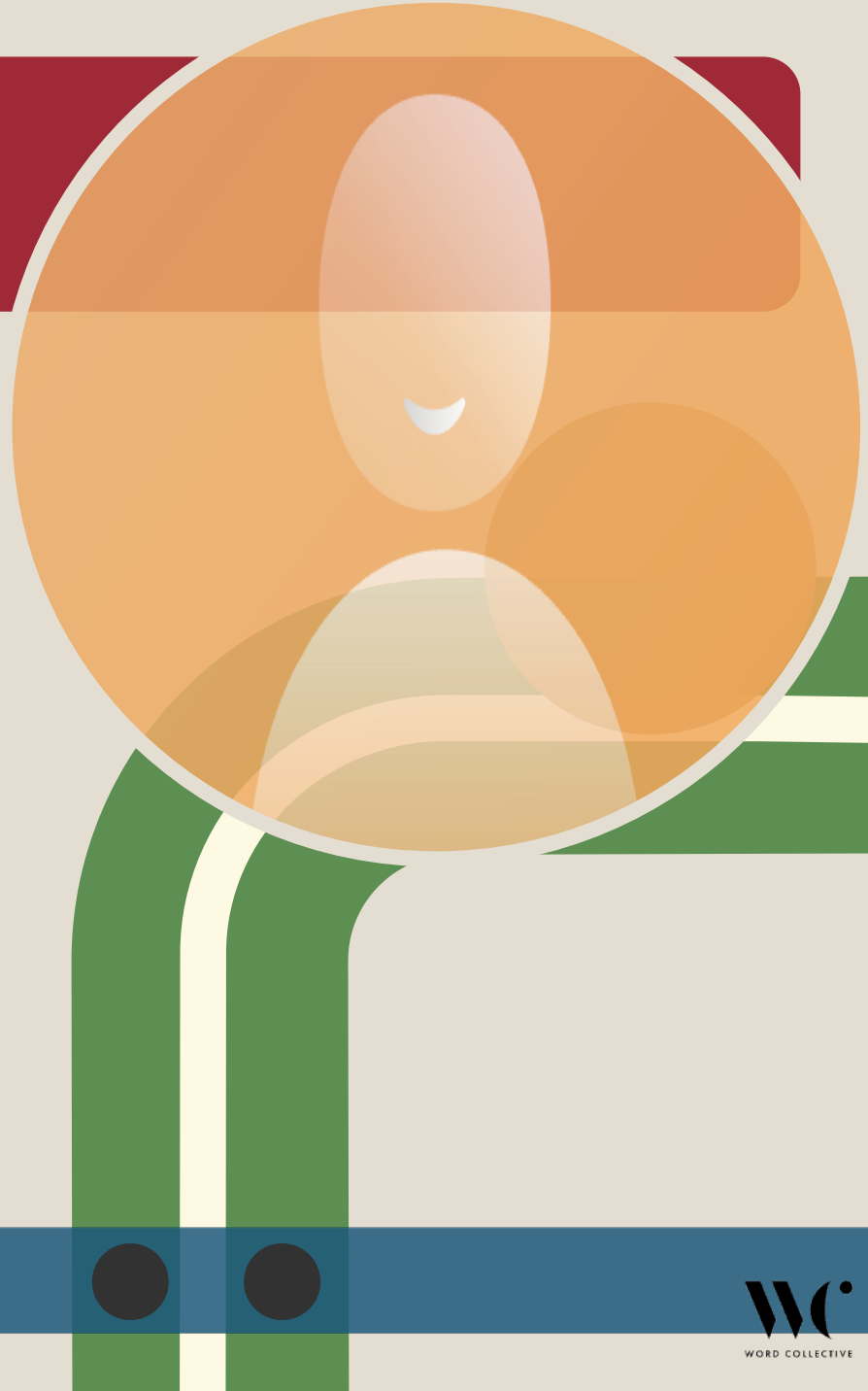
changing landscape of Bible translation



church-based Bible translation

oral Bible translation

Accessible exegesis:



- prevents “power over” dynamics
- follows the biblical example of making knowledge accessible
- supports oral theologians

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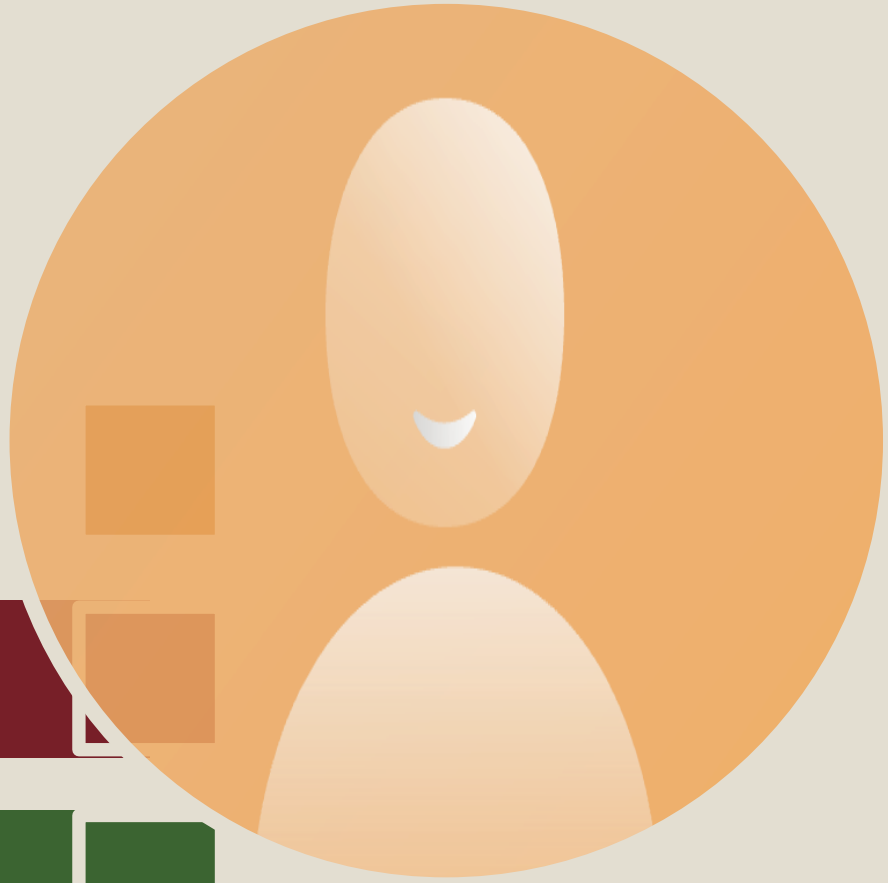
Physically accessible exegesis looks like:



- off-line
- lowered paywalls
- open-source

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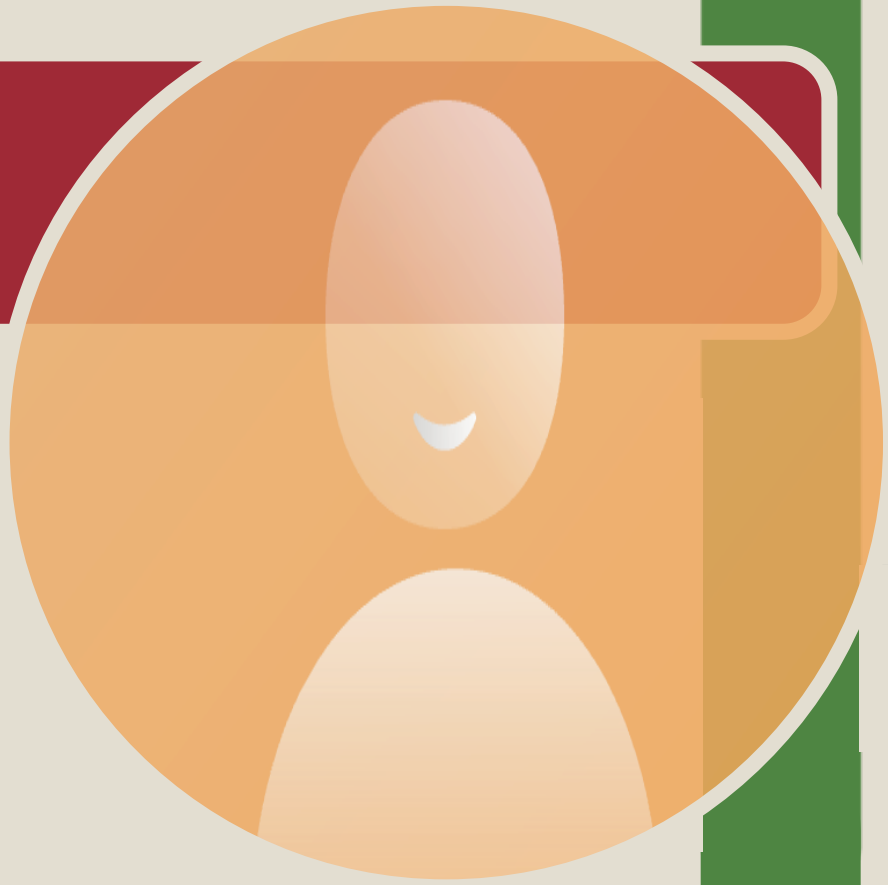
Characteristics of orality:



Narrative

Community

Embodied

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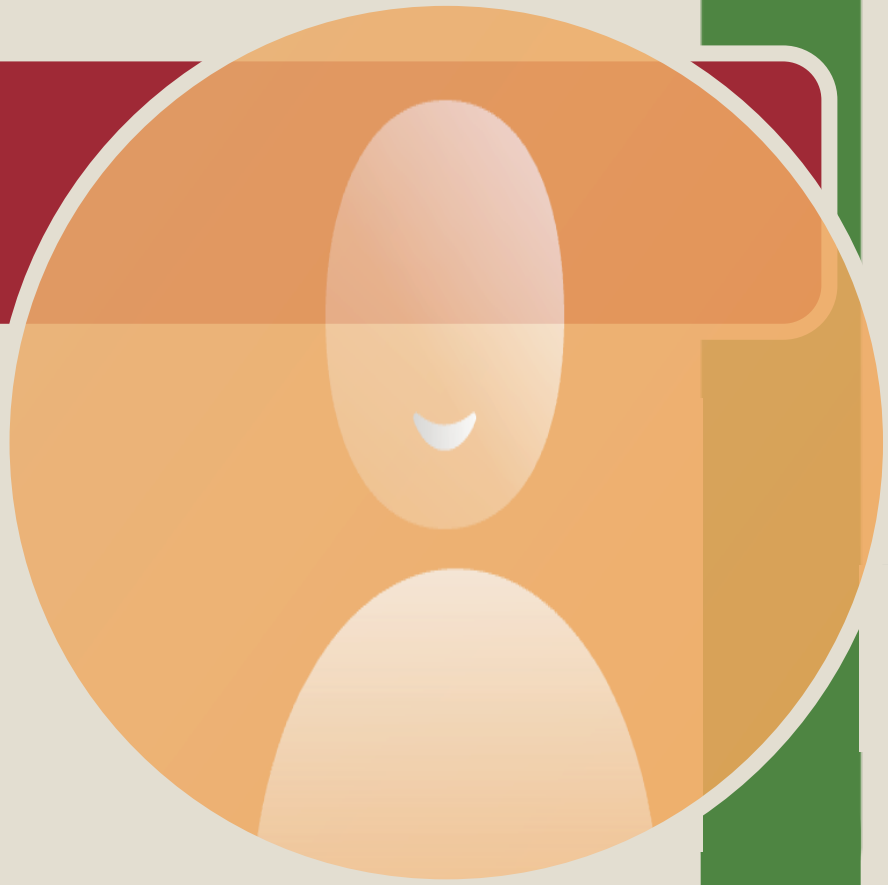
Characteristics of oral theology:



Narrative Rationality

Communal Semiotics

Embodied Epistemology

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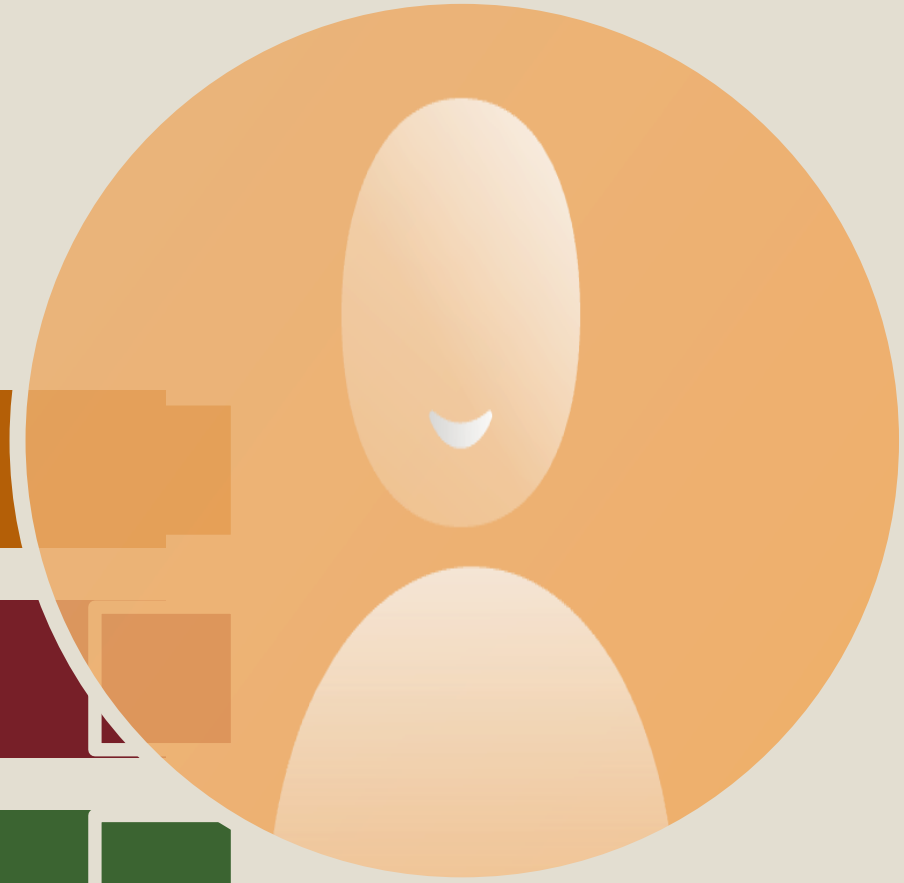
Accessible exegesis also looks like:

- audio formats
- oral processes
- translated materials
- oral-friendly materials
- oral-created materials



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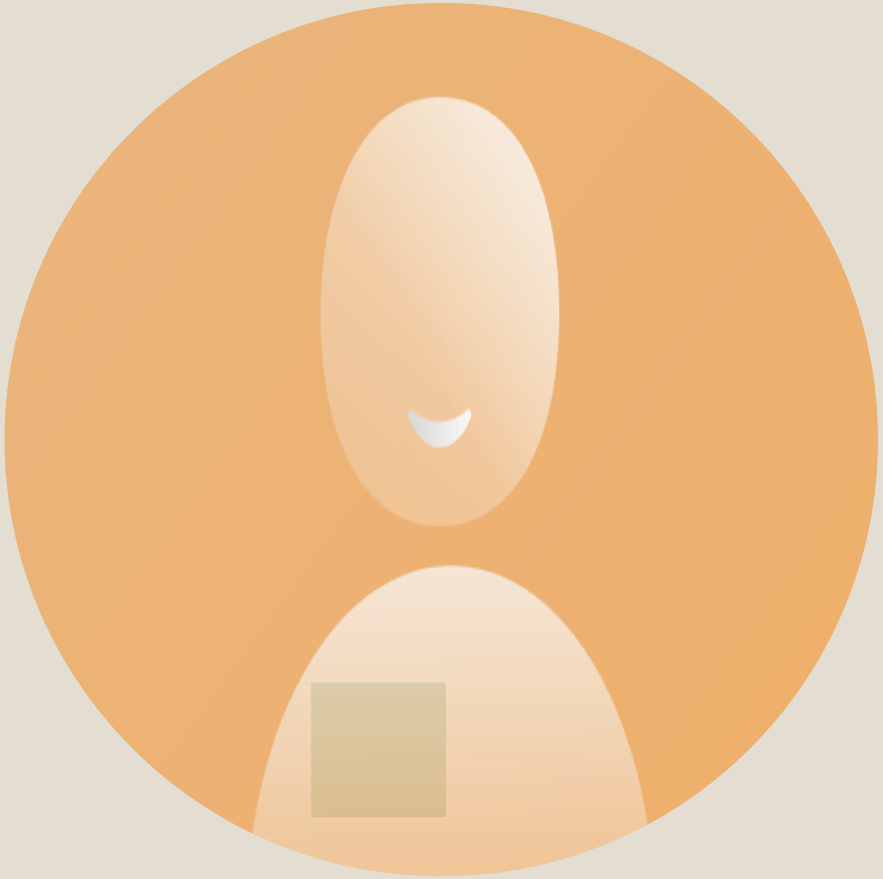
Oral learners and theologians do not need to be accommodated, they need to be recognized and supported by the global church.



- higher-quality translations, especially for primarily oral communities
- theological and interpretive insight from oral theologians
- ethical and sustainable translation processes and projects

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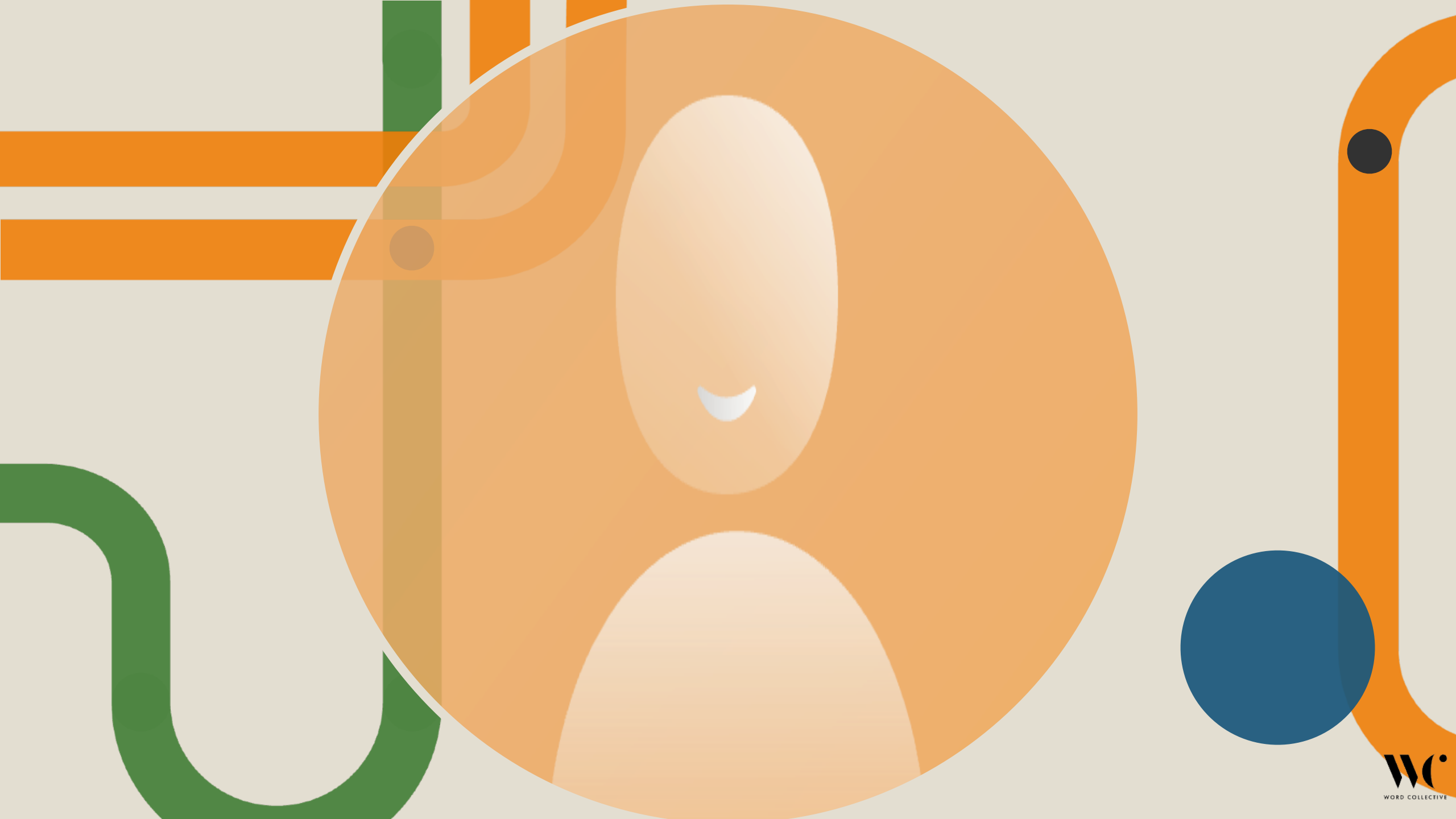

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